

● UNIT 2 · TOPIC 2.3

Fare Basis Codes

Cracking the airline code hidden in every ticket.

B.B.A. Aviation Management · Semester III · Unit 2: Fare Construction Principles
Air Ticketing & Fare Construction (2ACBAM32) · Arun Kumar

AIR TICKETING ACADEMY

ADMIT ONE LEARNER

No. 2.3

CLASS

SELF-STUDY

PERIOD

PERIOD 3

DURATION

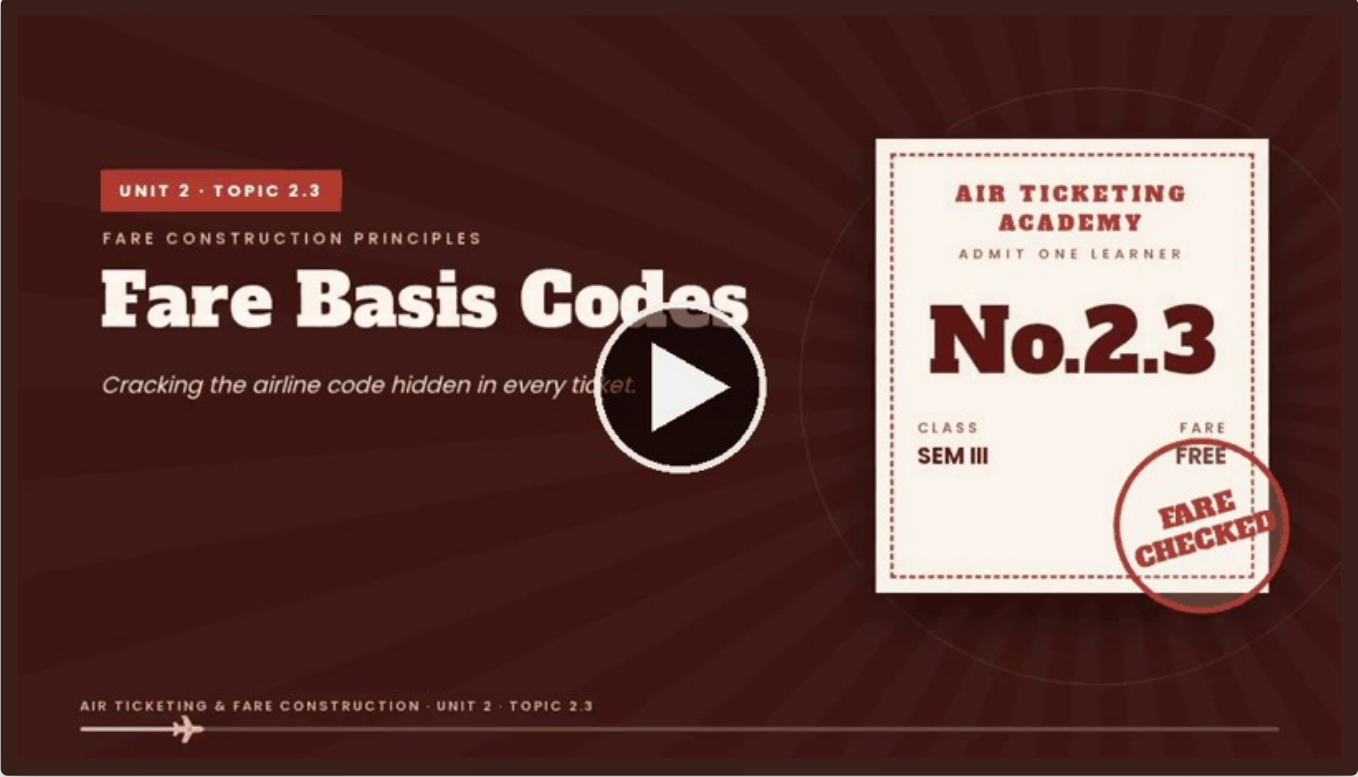
40 MIN

FARE

FREE**FARE
CHECKED**

● **TOPIC 2.3**

Now Showing: Topic Intro



UNIT 2 · TOPIC 2.3

FARE CONSTRUCTION PRINCIPLES

Fare Basis Codes

Cracking the airline code hidden in every ticket.

AIR TICKETING ACADEMY
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No.2.3

CLASS SEM III

FARE FREE

FARE CHECKED

AIR TICKETING & FARE CONSTRUCTION · UNIT 2 · TOPIC 2.3

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02

● TOPIC 2.3

The Ticket Puzzle

**THINK ABOUT IT**

What could the code “KLX14IN” printed on a ticket possibly mean?

**THINK**

30 seconds alone

**PAIR**

1 minute with a neighbour

**SHARE**

2-3 answers with the class



● TOPIC 2.3

Your Fare Itinerary

1

2.3.1

What are fare basis codes: the coding system used in the airline industry

2

2.3.2

Components: how codes show season, class and restrictions

3

2.3.3

Examples of fare basis codes for classes such as Y, S, B, M

4

2.3.4

How fare basis codes change with different rules and restrictions

**BY THE END, YOU WILL**

- Define a fare basis code
- Decode its common elements
- Interpret real-style examples
- Explain why codes change when rules change

Pedagogy: Individual Learning / Self-Study



● TOPIC 2.3.1

What Is a Fare Basis Code?

**Up to 8 characters**

Letters and numbers printed on every ticket coupon.

**Links to rules**

The code points to the full fare rule stored in ATPCO/GDS.

**Starts with RBD**

The first letter is almost always the booking class.

**DEFINITION**

A fare basis code is an alphanumeric code that identifies a specific fare and the rules attached to it — class, season, day of week, minimum stay, advance purchase and more.



● TOPIC 2.3.2

Common Building Blocks

Airlines design their own codes, but these conventions are widely used.

Position / letters	Typical meaning	Example
1st letter	Booking class (RBD)	Y, B, M, Q, J
H / L / K	Season: high, low, shoulder	YH, ML
W / X	Weekend / weekday	BWX
AP / 14 / 21	Advance purchase days	Q14
3M / 6M / 1Y	Maximum stay	K3M
OW / RT / EE	One-way / return / excursion	MOW, VEE



● TOPIC 2.3.2

Decoding a Fare Basis Code

Read left to right, like a sentence.

- Start with the first letter: the booking class.
- Look for season and day codes.
- Numbers usually mean advance purchase or stay limits.
- Final letters may show journey type or market (e.g., IN = India).



DECODER (illustrative)

FARE BASIS: KLX14IN

K -> booking class K

L -> low season

X -> weekday travel

14 -> 14-day advance purchase

IN -> India point of sale

// invented code for teaching



● TOPIC 2.3.3

Examples by Class

Same route, different codes, very different rules.

**Y / YIF**

Full-fare economy.
Fully flexible and
refundable; highest
economy price.

**M / B codes**

Mid-level economy,
e.g., MOW or BLRT:
some change fees,
moderate price.

**S / Q / V codes**

Discounted economy,
e.g., SLX21: advance
purchase, stay limits,
penalties.

**J / C codes**

Business class, e.g.,
JOW or CRT: flexible
premium fares.

● TOPIC 2.3.3

Practice: Read the Codes

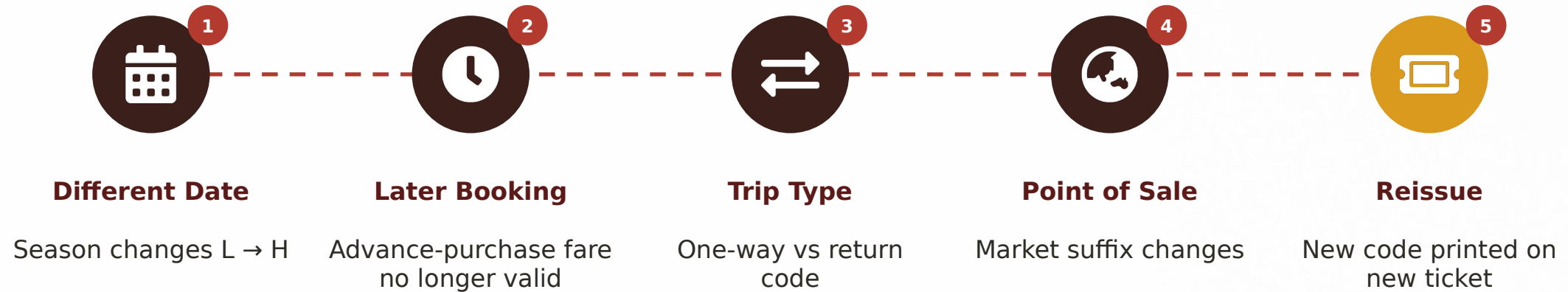
Code	Class	Likely features
YRT	Y	Full-fare economy round trip, flexible
MOWIN	M	One-way economy, sold in India
BHX7	B	High season, weekday, 7-day advance purchase
QLEE3M	Q	Low-season excursion fare, max stay 3 months
JOW	J	Business class one-way

Note: Codes are illustrative — always confirm with the fare rule (e.g., FQN in Amadeus).

TOPIC 2.3.4

Why Codes Change

Change the rule, change the code.



● TOPIC 2.3.4

Before & After a Change



Original Ticket

- Fare basis QLX21IN
- Low season, weekday
- 21-day advance purchase
- Lowest price

VS

After Date Change

- Fare basis MHWIN
- High season, weekend
- No advance purchase met
- Higher fare + change fee

● TOPIC 2.3.4

Self-Study Checklist

1

Identify the RBD letter

2

Spot season / day codes

3

Read the numbers (AP / stay)

4

Confirm with the fare rule



Practise with 10 real fare basis codes from any GDS or airline fare-rule page this week.



● TOPIC 2.3

Ticket Office Workshop: Code Breaker Worksheet



PEDAGOGY

Individual Learning / Self-Study**TIME · 12 min****FORMAT · Individual self-study****1**

Each student gets 10 fare basis codes.

2

Decode each: class, season, day, advance purchase, stay.

3

Mark any part you cannot decode and note what rule you would check.

4

Self-check using the answer sheet; discuss hardest ones.



● TOPIC 2.3

Click to reveal each answer

Fare Check Quiz

Q1

The first letter of a fare basis code usually shows...

- A) Season
- B) Booking class
- C) Airline
- D) Currency

ANSWER**B****Q2**

In many codes, “H” indicates...

- A) High season
- B) Hotel included
- C) Half fare
- D) Holiday only

ANSWER**A****Q3**

“14” in a fare basis code most often means...

- A) 14 kg baggage
- B) 14-day advance purchase
- C) 14 stopovers
- D) Seat 14

ANSWER**B****Q4**

The final authority on a code’s meaning is...

- A) The code letters
- B) The fare rule
- C) The passenger
- D) The seat map

ANSWER**B**

TICKET STAMPED

Key Takeaways

- ✓ Fare basis codes identify a fare and its rules
- ✓ First letter = RBD; other letters show season, day, journey type
- ✓ Numbers usually mean advance purchase or stay limits
- ✓ Change the conditions and the code (and price) change

EXIT TICKET Write 1 thing you learned today + 1 question you still have.

NEXT TICKET**Topic 2.4 — Types of Fares**

Thank you · Questions?